

Br. Abdessamad, Mathematics

Findings from the principal's review of student manuals and workbooks

To	Br. Abdessamad
Subjects	Mathematics, all levels except Grade 4
From	Mufti Mirza-Zain Baig, Principal
Date	Thursday, 11 September 2026

As Salam Alaykum Wa Rahmatullahi Wa Barakatuhu,

What I found in Secondary 2

I reviewed the Secondary 2 math workbooks. The work that exists is on page six, the students have been writing directly in the books at question four, and there is no correction. The correction is not supposed to be inside the book. Page one is finished, page three has nothing done in the manual, and the correction that was done sits on one page while the next page is untouched. In honesty, looking at it I could not tell what the purpose of the book is right now, it is a few pages done and the rest empty.

What I found in the other levels

The other groups show the same pattern as Secondary 2. The work that was assigned is not being done properly and the progression is not being tracked, so it is impossible to tell from the books who is behind and why.

In Grade 5 and Grade 6 the correction is not done properly, and the word problems are being skipped in large numbers. The word problems cannot be skipped. They need to be completed with much more rigour than they are getting now, and the challenge questions should also be done wherever possible, the students need the exposure. Word problems are part of the Grade 6 exam, so this is not optional.

Tracking

Keep a sample of the work for tracking purposes. Work with each of the exercises you told them to do, and assign specific parts, for example only part two, so that you can separate the students who are lazy from the students who are genuinely not able to do the work. Set a page target for each group and write down where they are, so that when you give them more time they move on to the next target. When a target is not met, write that down too, because it means the work was not done properly.

What I expect moving forward

Correction is done properly on every page, outside the book where the book is not meant for it, and nothing is left half corrected.

Word problems are completed in full and with rigour at every level, and no word problem is skipped. Print extra word problems for Grade 6 since they are on the exam.

Challenge questions are done wherever possible for exposure.

Anything that is extra or not needed is circled in blue rather than having a name written on it, so that it is known at a glance.

A page target and a written progression record per group, updated as they advance, so we can distinguish the lazy from the struggling and act on each.

Where things are going well, correction can be more positive, the students should see that too.

I know the load is heavy at the start of the year and I appreciate the work you are putting in. Please go through your groups' manuals this week with the points above in mind and confirm with me once it is done. May Allah reward you and put barakah in your efforts.

Jazakallah khayra,

(Mufti) Mirza-Zain Baig

Principal, Dar Al-'Ulum Montreal